

IaaS vs PaaS vs SaaS (AWS Comparison)



1-Page Comparison Chart

Feature	IaaS (Infrastructure as a Service)	PaaS (Platform as a Service)	SaaS (Software as a Service)
Definition	Provides virtualized computing resources over the internet	Provides a platform to develop, run, and manage applications	Provides ready-to-use software over the internet
User Control	Full control (OS, runtime, apps)	Control over apps & data only	No control (just use software)
Management	User manages everything except hardware	Provider manages infrastructure & runtime	Provider manages everything
Setup Complexity	High	Medium	Low
Flexibility	Very high	Moderate	Low
Use Case	Custom infrastructure, hosting servers	App development & deployment	End-user applications



AWS Examples



IaaS (Infrastructure)

- **Amazon EC2 (Elastic Compute Cloud)** → Virtual servers
- **Amazon EBS (Elastic Block Store)** → Storage volumes
- **Amazon VPC (Virtual Private Cloud)** → Networking environment



PaaS (Platform)

- **AWS Elastic Beanstalk** → Deploy apps without managing servers
- **AWS Lambda** → Serverless compute (run code without servers)
- **Amazon RDS (Relational Database Service)** → Managed databases



SaaS (Software)

- **Amazon WorkDocs** → Document collaboration
- **Amazon WorkMail** → Email & calendar service

- **Amazon Chime** → Communication & meetings
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Quick Summary

- **IaaS** → "You control everything" (like renting a machine)
 - **PaaS** → "You focus on code" (platform handles infra)
 - **SaaS** → "Just use the app" (no setup needed)
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Simple Analogy

- **IaaS** = Renting land → You build everything
- **PaaS** = Renting a kitchen → You cook food
- **SaaS** = Ordering food → Ready to eat